Waleed Iqbal

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Short Bio

I have experience of cutting-edge research and teaching in prestigious institutes including Northeastern University London, UK, Queen Mary University of London (QMUL), UK, and Information Technology University (ITU), Pakistan. I have authored (and co-authored) more than 14 research papers in leading peer-reviewed international journals and conference proceedings. Out of those, six papers are 4* REF papers and seven papers are 3* REF papers. I regularly publish in top-tier research venues such as AAAI ICWSM and ACM IMC. I currently serve as Assistant Professor in Data Science at Northeastern University London, where I lead Level 6 and 7 modules and supervise MSc dissertations. As a Teaching Fellow at Queen Mary University of London (QMUL), I lectured and co-lectured undergraduate courses serving hundreds of students, employing student-centric and active learning approaches. I am also a Fellow of the Higher Education Academy, UK (AdvanceHE).

Experience

Assistant Professor in Data Science, Northeastern University London, UK **July 2025–Present**

- Module Lead of Level 6 and 7 courses (PG).
- Dissertation supervisor for MSc Data Science and Analytics.
- Member, Central Research Ethics Approval Board.
- Central Person of Contact, Amazon Web Services Academy - Northeastern University London.

Director of Artificial Intelligence, Ibtidah Solutions Global Ltd. **March 2023–Present**

- Leading Machine Learning team on data analytics and model designs.
- Strategic recommendations for AI infrastructure building.

Lecturer in Data Science, Northeastern University London, UK **January 2025–June 2025**

- Module Leader of Advanced Data Engineering (PG).
- Dissertation supervisor for MSc Data Science and Analytics .

Teaching Fellow, Queen Mary University of London, UK **September 2022–September 2026**

- Module co-lecturer for ECS417U Fundamentals of Web Technologies.
- MSc Final Dissertation Supervision in School of EECS
- Undergraduate Final Year Project Supervisions in School of EECS

Consultant, Machine Learning, Ibtidah Solutions Ltd., Lahore, Pakistan **March 2020–March 2023**

- Consultancy for Machine Learning team building.
- Advising Machine Learning team on data analytics and model design.
- Strategic recommendations for client's system design.

Lab Demonstrator, Queen Mary University of London, UK **September 2020–September 2022**

- Courses Assisted: ECS607U/ECS766P Data Mining (UG, PG), ECS417U Fundamentals of Web Technologies (UG), ECS781A/P Cloud Computing (PG), ECS780P Computer Programming (UG), ECS637U/ECS757P Digital Media and Social Networks (UG, PG).

Research Associate, IT University Lahore, Pakistan **November 2015–December 2019**

Projects:

- Scientometric Analysis of Computer Networking Research.
- Evaluation Study of link quality in 802.15.4 Zigbee Protocol.
- Performance evaluation of Educational Volunteers in Government School.

Teaching Assistant, IT University Lahore, Pakistan **November 2015–December 2019**

- Courses Assisted: Computer Networking (UG), Operating Systems (UG), Data Structures (UG), Object Oriented Programming (UG), Advanced Operating Systems (PG), Advanced Topics in Artificial Intelligence (PG).

EDUCATION

Post Graduate Certificate in Academic Practice, Queen Mary University of London, UK **2025–2026**
- Funded By: Queen Mary Academy

Ph.D. Computer Science, Queen Mary University of London, UK **2020– 2025**
- Thesis: Exploring online manifestation of real-world realities.
- Funded By: Queen Mary Postgraduate Research Studentships

M.S. Computer Science, IT University Lahore, Pakistan **2015–2018**
- Thesis: Analysis of Computer Networking Research: A Bibliometric Study.
- Funded By: Information Technology University Graduate Student Fellowship.

B.Sc. Electrical Engineering, University of the Punjab, Pakistan. **2009–2013**
- Dissertation: Analysis of VoIP Structure and Standards: Deployment of an Open Source VoIP Network for an Organization with Enhanced Services.

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

[1] Elmahjub, Ezieddin, Junaid Qadir, Abdullah Mushtaq, Rafay Naeem, Ibrahim Ghaznavi, and **Waleed Iqbal** "Islamiclegalbench: Evaluating llms knowledge and reasoning of islamic law across 1,200 years of islamic pluralist legal traditions." Artificial Intelligence and Law **2026**

[2] **Iqbal, Waleed**, Vahid Ghafouri, Gareth Tyson, Guillermo Suarez-Tangil, and Ignacio Castro. "Lady and the Tramp Nextdoor: Online Manifestations of Real-World Inequalities in the Nextdoor Social Network." *In Proceedings of the International AAAI Conference on Web and Social Media (ICWSM)* **2023**.

[3] **Iqbal, Waleed**, Muhammad Haseeb Arshad, Gareth Tyson, and Ignacio Castro. "Exploring crowdsourced content moderation through lens of Reddit during COVID-19." *In Proceedings of the 17th Asian internet engineering conference (AINTEC)* **2022**.

[4] Javed, R. Tallal, Muhammad Usama, **Waleed Iqbal**, Junaid Qadir, Gareth Tyson, Ignacio Castro, and Kiran Garimella. "A deep dive into COVID-19-related messages on WhatsApp in Pakistan." *Social Network Analysis and Mining* **2022**.

[5] McQuistin, Stephen, Mladen Karan, Prashant Khare, Colin Perkins, Gareth Tyson, Matthew Purver, Patrick Healey, **Waleed Iqbal**, Junaid Qadir, and Ignacio Castro. "Characterising the IETF through the lens of RFC deployment." *In Proceedings of the 21st ACM Internet Measurement Conference*, pp. 137-149. 2021. doi: 10.1145/3487552.3487821

[6] Latif, Siddique, Muhammad Usman, Sanaullah Manzoor, **Waleed Iqbal**, Junaid Qadir, Gareth Tyson, Ignacio Castro, Adeel Razi, Maged N. Kamel Boulos, Adrian Weller, and Jon Crowcroft. "Leveraging data science to combat COVID-19: A comprehensive review." *IEEE Transactions on Artificial Intelligence* **2020**.

[7] **Iqbal, Waleed**, Junaid Qadir, Gareth Tyson, Adnan Noor Mian, Saeed-ul Hassan, and Jon Crowcroft. "A bibliometric analysis of publications in computer networking research." *Scientometrics* **2019**.

FUNDINGS AND GRANTS

Co-Principal Investigator, Neighbourhood Signals: Online Discussions and Crime, National Research Centre on Privacy, Harm Reduction and Adversarial Influence Online (REPHRAIN) - UKRI (£23,794) **Dec 2025 - April 2026**

Travel Grant, Oxford LLM Workshop, Department of Sociology, University of Oxford **2023**

Travel Grant, ACM Internet Measurement Conference, Nice, France **2022**

AWARDS

Fellow, Higher Education Academy, AdvanceHE, United Kingdom **2026**

Global Talent Visa (Exceptional Talent in Research and Academic Category), United Kingdom **2023**

Queen Mary Principal PhD Studentship, Queen Mary University of London, UK **2020**

Dean's Roll of Honor for MS Computer Science, IT University Lahore, Pakistan **2018**

Graduate Student Fellowship, IT University Lahore, Pakistan **2015**

Dean's Roll of Honor for BSc Electrical Engineering, University of The Punjab, Pakistan **2014**

Professional Training and Courses

Natural Language Processing with Classification and Vector Spaces, Coursera — **Mar 2023**

Version Control, Coursera — **Aug 2023**

Neural Network and Deep Learning, Coursera — **Sep 2017**

Technical Skills

Programming Python, C++, C Language, and Javascript.

Technical Tools Jupyter Notebook, Tableau, Telerik Fiddler, Gephi, SPSS, Git, and Postman API Platform.

Academic Services

Working Group Member IEEE EDU P3722 Guide for Responsible Artificial Intelligence (AI) in Higher Education — **2026/27**

Senior Technical Program Committee Member AAAI Conference on Web and Social Media (ICWSM) **2027**

Reviewer IEEE Global Engineering Education Conference (EDUCON) — **2026, 2025**

Organizing Committee Member IEEE Global Engineering Education Conference (EDUCON) **2025**

Reviewer ACM The Web Conference (WWW) **2025**

Reviewer AAAI Conference on Web and Social Media (ICWSM) **2025, 2023**

Shadow TPC Member ACM Internet Measurement Conference (IMC) **2022**

Reviewer Springer Scientometrics **2019**

Reviewer ACM SIGCOMM Computer Communication Review (CCR) **2019**

References

References will be provided upon request.